

Making a splash

Many birds dive-bomb fish at sea, but the common kingfisher catches its prey in freshwater. It needs clear water to hunt and spots fish by watching carefully from a perch. If it sees a fish, it may dive right away, but often it hovers, gauging the fish's exact position. Once ready, the kingfisher plunges into the water with its beak slightly open. A split-second later, it carries the fish back to its perch. The bird stuns the fish with a few sharp blows against the perch and swallows it headfirst.

